

significantly reducing global warming emissions.”

“Governments and associations across the globe are taking steps to potentially increase the inexhaustible sources of energy—wind and solar. Several initiatives are being taken to expand their ambitions to get rid of fossil fuels in heating, cooling, transport, and industry. Clean energy also reduces harmful smog, a toxic build-up in the air we breathe and water we consume, and the impacts caused by coal mining and gas extraction. By replacing our fossil-fuel infrastructure and building stronger renewable energy generation, we can create a sustainable energy future and reduce the impact on climate change,” he adds.

According to the Indian startup Loom Solar, a ‘decade of adoption’ for the global transition to renewable energy was scheduled to commence in 2020. Most of the segments were definitely struck by the pandemic that has taken the wind out of their sails. There has been some progress in the transition, according to the 2019 Renewables Global Status Report from REN21, a leading think tank on renewable energy. The majority of new electricity production is in renewable energy format. Promises to decarbonise renewable energy and oil have been made by around more than 160 nations.

The international conversion to clean energy

Today, governments of all the countries are reacting to the economic effects of the pandemic by introduc-

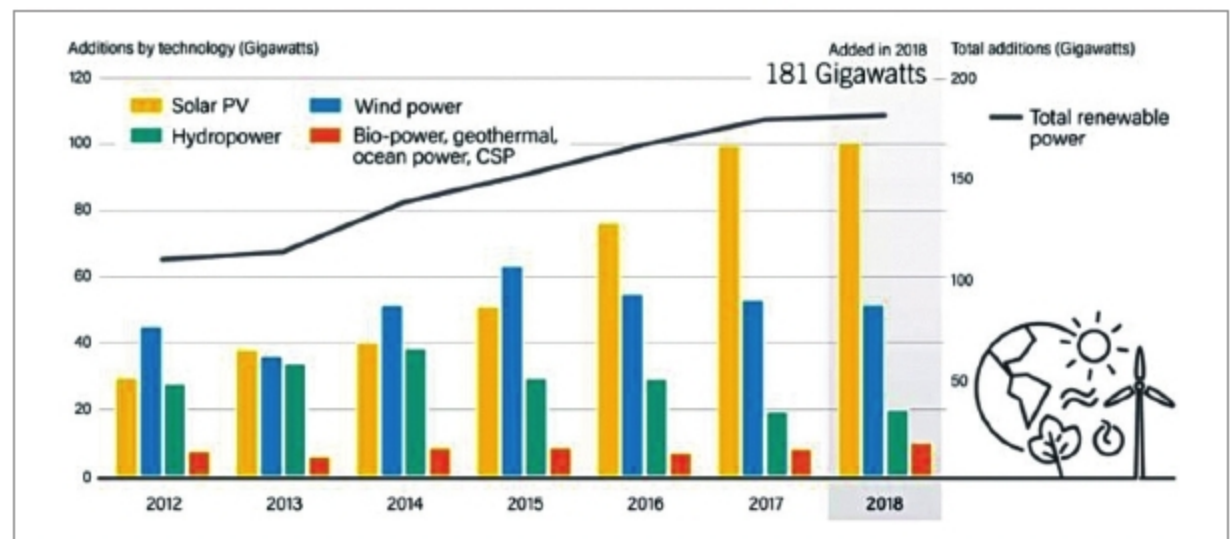


Fig. 1: Total renewable energy additions in 2018

ing unprecedented steps, but they are also neglecting the major issues like energy and climate. India ranks third over renewable energy expenditure and plans, as per a new study by British Business Energy. In the meantime, renewable energy is expected to almost double in India by 2022.

According to the Renewables Global Status Report (GSR), worldwide carbon emissions are not reducing fast enough. Second, the international subsidies to fossil fuels were about eleven per cent between 2016 and 2017 that reached 300 billion dollars in a year. The report also revealed that the total investment in renewable energy was about 288.9 billion dollars in 2018, which is far less than the subsidies provided to fossil fuels.

The shifting of renewable energy in the electricity sector has escalated, and globally more and more renewable energy capacity has been installed rather than new nuclear and fossil fuel capacity. Around 181GW of new renewables capacity was installed in 2018, which is now more than one-

third of the worldwide installed power.

Fig. 1 clearly explains that bio-power and wind power are somewhat stable, but hydropower energy is quite down. It is because renewable capacity additions are primarily growing in solar PV panels. If we count all the major renewable energy capacity installed globally in 2018, 55 per cent (about 100GW) was solar PV, wind power was 28 per cent, and hydropower 11 per cent.

When it comes to energy installations, China is still ahead of most of the developed nations (Fig. 2). Back in 2018, it recorded the highest investment in renewable energy installation and is spearheading the world in terms of installed capacity of hydropower, solar PV, and wind.

During the Covid-19 lockdown period, the demand for other uses of renewable energy has declined, but renewable electricity is unaffected. Renewable energy in the form of bio-fuels reduced in Q1 2020 because the consumption of blended fuels for road transport fell. According to experts, the total worldwide utilisation of renewable energy would increase by only one per cent in the year 2020. Despite global supply chain disruptions that have delayed industrial activity in several key regions, the expansion of wind, hydropower, and solar is expected to help augment renewable electricity generation to five per cent by the end of 2020.

In Q1 2020, as per *iea.org*, the global use of renewable energy was 1.5 per cent higher than in Q1 2019. The increase was driven by a rise of about three per cent in renewable electricity generation after more than 100GW of solar PV and about 60GW of

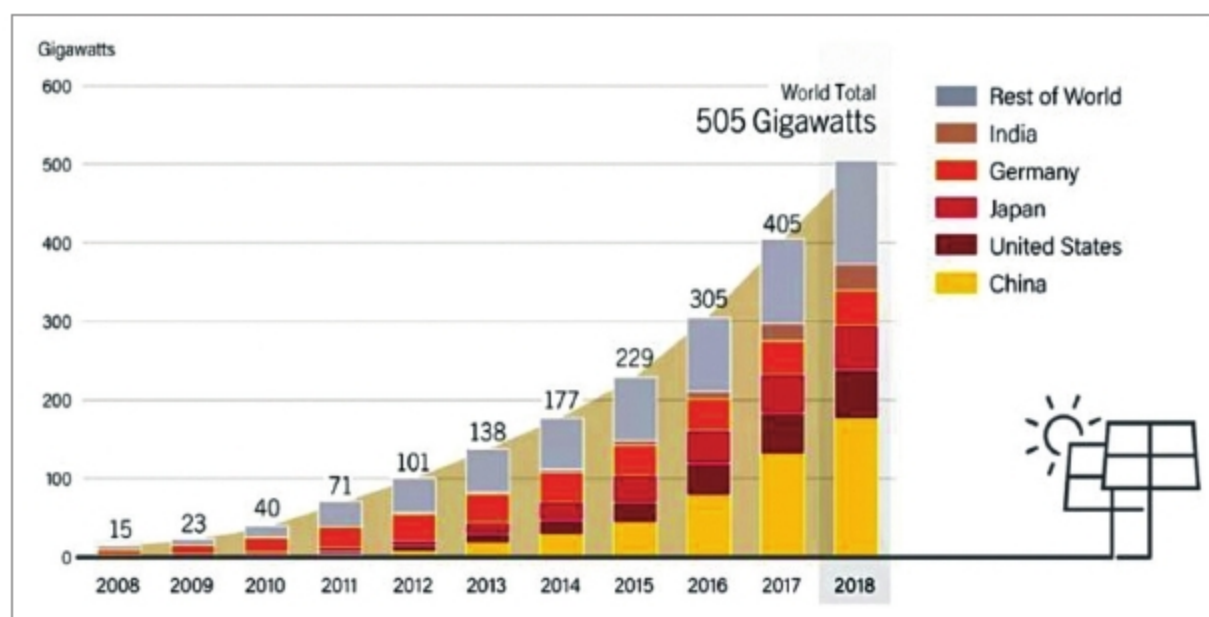


Fig. 2: Solar PV global capacity, by country and region, 2008-2018